

Care at Home

The Manipal Group has come up with a brand new healthcare service. One phone call and the newly-launched Manipal Homecare scheme would take quality healthcare to the privacy of a patient's

Dr Dalela's sheath is transparent & soft. The market offers sturdy and opaque alternatives.

The new option can be used several times. Commercial sheaths can be used only once.

The new sheath costs about Rs 100. Branded ones cost over Rs 4,000.



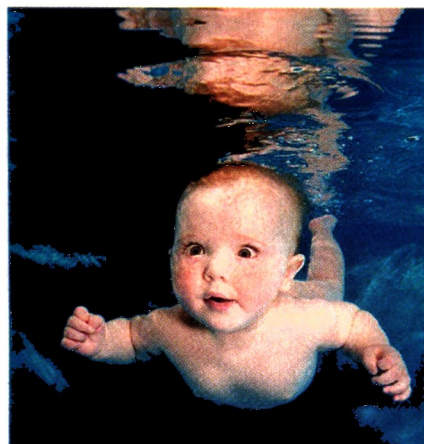
home. Patients who need regular checkups and find it inconvenient to commute to a hospital can now lie in comfort and get much-needed medical services—from injections, blood tests, dressing changes, BP monitorings, bath, bed-making, back care to vaccinations. Sending in a GP to a patient's home to linking up a patient through a web camera with specialists at Manipal hospitals in Bangalore, Mangalore and Manipal are in the pipeline too.

84%

OF PRIVATE HOSPITALS IN INDIA HAVE LESS THAN 30 BEDS. ONLY 1 PER CENT HAVE OVER 200 BEDS.

Sports Gene Test

Just a mouth swab. But parents can now get to know which sport their child is most suited for. Super Religare Laboratories has launched India's first Sports Gene Test. At its root is the ACTN-3 gene, widely known as the Sports Gene. Everybody carries two copies of this gene—one from each parent. It produces a protein that helps fast-twitch muscle fibres needed for rapid, forceful muscle contraction and high-energy surges. From genotypes of ACTN-3, the test will show up (in children between age two and 13) if there's some sort of genetic advantage for sport—high intensity, endurance or power. Genes do not predict athletic ability in a particular sport by themselves, they just indicate the natural advantage a child may have. You need right training, nutrition and motivation along with it.



PLASTIC INNOVATION

At a time when healthcare costs are spiralling out of control, here's a cost-effective innovation to help patients suffering from kidney stones. Dr Diwakar Dalela, professor and head of the urology, CSM Medical University, Lucknow, has designed an Amplatz Sheath (a foot-long pipe that facilitates the entry of a nephroscope into the body to remove the stones). Unlike the available market options, Dalela's sheath is made up of white plastic with a radio opaque ring at the tip. The ring enables fluoroscopic visualisation and the white colour allows greater reflection of endoscopic light—permitting precise and complex manipulations. The sheath has won the best innovation award at the 43rd annual conference of the Urological Society of India.

by Subhash Mishra

TENDER SWIMMERS

Teaching babies how to swim helps develop a range of motor skills, say scientists. Researchers from Britain and Norway (published this month in the journal, *Child: Care, Health and Development*) analysed baby swimmers aged two to three months and found that those who took swimming classes performed better on tests involving gripping, reaching and balance.

■ Compiled by Damayanti Datta